

STRENGTHENING LEGACY

IIMC stays its ground despite job market pressures, launches cutting-edge courses in AI, corporate sustainability, and private equity

BY GEORGE SKARIA

28 | **T**HE MORE THINGS change, the more they remain the same. This adage by the 19th-century French critic, author, and journalist Jean-Baptiste Alphonse Karr seems apt in the case of Indian Institute of Management-Calcutta (IIMC) when comparing its progress this year in the BT-MDRA Best B-Schools Survey to the previous year. With U.S. President Donald Trump's tariffs on several countries, including India, and the growing use of artificial intelligence (AI) leading to job cuts, business schools were expected to feel the impact on placements, admissions, and recruitment trends. IIMC has been able to hold its ground.

"As the global business environment grows increasingly dynamic, IIM Calcutta leads with purpose—fostering innovation, nurturing responsible leadership, and preparing professionals to thrive in an ever-evolving world," says Professor Alok Kumar Rai, Director, IIMC.

The consulting sector led the hiring process in academic year

(AY) 2024-25. Further, there was an increase in the number of Indian start-ups participating in the hiring process. The median salary increased from ₹30 lakh per annum in the previous academic year to ₹34 lakh.

Frequent recruiters, from Google, Amazon and ITC to the lesser-known ones like TrueTech and Saifee Hospital, continued hiring. The approved intake of the MBA programme remained the same at 480, though. In AY 2024-25, it introduced 14 new courses; the Executive Education

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(ExEd) division delivered 167 programmes that engaged over 8,000 professionals across open, customised, and consultancy formats.

AY 2024-25 was also the year that saw the launch of cutting-edge courses in AI, corporate sustainability, and private equity. It was also a year of new initiatives, sponsorships, and expanded industry networks, marked by a significant increase in industry engagement, doubling the number of interactions to over 105 industry experts compared to the previous year. There was also a rise in inclusivity-based courses such as Climate Change, Managing Diversity & Inclusivity, and Responsible AI. Further, two new modules were introduced in international immersion programmes, including a live project on Hydrogen in SDA Bocconi Milan, Italy (main campus), and entrepreneurship in ESADE, Barcelona, Spain. Despite these value additions, the fees remained unchanged at ₹31 lakh. These developments align with IIMC's traditional strengths, like a loyal network of 45,000 alumni built over six decades, a vibrant